MIL-B-43716B
30 September 1985
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-43716A
9 February 1976

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BAGS, PLASTIC, PROTECTIVE (GARMENT)

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers the requirements for plastic garment bags (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. The bags shall be furnished in the following types and sizes as specified (see 6.2):

Type I	- Preformed for trousers
Type II	- Preformed for suits and jackets
Type III	- Preformed for dresses and coats

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

* 2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-601	- Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data that may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8105

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STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads

(Copies of documents required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The garment bags shall be fabricated from heat sealable polyethylene tubing. The material shall be transparent.

3.1.1 Tubing. Polyethylene tubing furnished in roll form shall be clear and free of specks and gels. Care shall be exercised to eliminate undue tension of rolls in creasing side edges of tubing during the manufacturing process or winding the tubing on rolls.

3.2 Construction. Bags of preformed tubing material shall be seal seamed at top end of bag in accordance with industry practice. The seam shall be compatible with the design of a commercial coat and pants hanger with a slit opening not less than a nominal 2 1/2 inches in width to accommodate the coat hanger hook. The bags shall be designed with 4-inch lengthwise gussets conforming to industry practice.

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3.3 Rolls. Bags shall be uniformly and smoothly wound on tubes of not less than 3-inch inside diameter. Types I, II, and III rolls of bags shall be furnished in lengths of 3000 feet, +200/-5 feet (see 6.2). The length of the tube shall be equal to the specified width of the bags, and a minimum of 1/8 inch of tube shall be visible at each end after bags have been wound on the roll. Perforations shall be cut between each bag on the roll. Perforations shall be straight, continuous, and cut clean through the width of each bag. Perforations shall not be located to impair the strength of the sealed seams. When used as intended, each bag shall easily detach from the roll.

* 3.4 Dimensions. Bag dimensions shall be the measurements, inclusive of seals, seams, or gussets, as specified in table I.

TABLE I. Bag dimensions

Type	Length (in.)1/	Width (in.)2/	Minimum thickness of material
I	30	21 3/	0.0005
II	36	21	0.0005
III	54	21	0.0005

1/ Length may be ± 1/2 inch of indicated dimension.

2/ Width may be ± 3/16 inch of indicated dimension.

3/ Width is in addition to 4-inch side gusset.

3.5 Danger warning marking. On one side of each bag, repeated every 16, 18, or 20 inches, the following warning shall be printed in white characters, not less than 3/8 inch in height:

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DANGER WARNING

TO AVOID SUFFOCATION,
KEEP AWAY FROM INFANTS AND CHILDREN

DO NOT USE IN CRIBS, BEDS,
CARRIAGES AND PLAY PENS

THIS BAG IS NOT A TOY

3.6 Workmanship. The bags shall be uniformly made, free from holes, tears, cuts, creases, wrinkles or other surface imperfections which might impair their usefulness.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the document where such inspections are deemed necessary to ensure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase documents.

4.2.2 End item inspection. The plastic bags shall be examined in accordance with 4.2.2.1 and 4.2.2.2.

4.2.2.1 Visual examination of plastic bags. The plastic bags shall be examined for the defects listed in table II. The lot size shall be all rolls of bags of the same type offered for inspection at one time, as applicable. The sample unit shall be one roll. The inspection level shall be S-3, and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 2.5 for major defects and 10.0 for total defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

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TABLE II. Visual defects

Examine	Defect	Category	
		Major	Minor
Construction	Thickness of material not as specified	101	
	Not fabricated in type specified	102	
	Danger warning marking not as specified	103	
	Bag dimensions not as specified	104	
	Perforations missing between bags	105	
	Bag does not detach from roll, as specified	106	
	Seam and hole for wire coat hanger not as specified	107	
	Chipboard tube missing or dimensions not as specified	108	
	Material not free of specks or gels		201
	Perforations not straight or not cut clean through width of roll		202
Workmanship	Tear, cut, or hole	109	
	Creases, sharp wrinkles, or surface imperfection in body or sealed areas which impair the utility of the bag		203

4.2.2.2 Examination for unit package count. The sample unit for this examination shall be one unit package. The inspection level shall be S-2. The lot shall be rejected if the sample data indicates a lot average length less than amount of bags specified per roll.

4.2.3 Packaging inspection. An examination shall be made to determine that preservation, packing, and markings comply with the requirements of section 5. Examination shall be for defects listed in table III. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers offered for inspection at one time. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-3, and the AQL shall be 2.5 for major defects and 10.0 for total defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

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TABLE III. Packaging inspection

Examine	Defect	Category	
		Major	Minor
Preservation	Not level specified	111	
	Unit pack not packed as specified	112	
	Roll of bags not suitably restrained from unwinding		205
	Container not close fitting		206
	Roll of bags not of like description	113	
Packing	Not level specified	114	
	Container not type specified	115	
	Rolls of bags not of like description	116	
	Gross weight exceeds box limitations	117	
Marking	Omitted; incomplete; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application	118	

* 4.2.4 Examination for palletization. An examination shall be made to determine that the palletization complies with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table IV. The lot size shall be the number of palletized unit loads in the end item inspection lot. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-1, and the AQL shall be 6.5, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

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TABLE IV. Examination of palletization

Examine	Defect
Finished dimension	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirement
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified Interlocking of loads not as specified Load not bonded with required straps as specified
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limit
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A, B, or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. A roll of bags of like description shall be suitably restrained from unwinding and shall be unit packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box conforming to end opening style RSC, grade W6c of PPP-B-636. The fiberboard box shall be closed method IV in accordance with the appendix of the box document.

5.1.2 Level B. A roll of bags of like description shall be suitably restrained from unwinding and shall be unit packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box conforming to end opening style RSC, type CF, class domestic, variety SW, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. The fiberboard box shall be closed method IV in accordance with the appendix of the box document.

* 5.1.3 Commercial. The rolls of bags shall be preserved in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

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5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Rolls of bags of like description preserved as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in fiberboard shipping containers conforming to style RSC, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The weight of contents shall be not more than 70 pounds. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of the container document. When specified (see 6.2), rolls of bags preserved as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in boxes conforming to overseas type, style optional of PPP-B-601. The weight of contents shall not exceed 200 pounds. The boxes shall be strapped in accordance with the appendix of the container document.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Rolls of bags of like description preserved as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in fiberboard shipping containers conforming to style RSC, type CF or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The box shall be closed in accordance with method II of the appendix to the container document. The weight of the contents shall not exceed 70 pounds.

5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant containers. When specified (see 6.2), boxes shall be made from grade V3c, V3s, or V4s material in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of the container document.

* 5.2.3 Commercial packing. Rolls of bags, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

* 5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), rolls of bags, packed as specified in 5.2, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type I or Ia, as applicable, of MIL-STD-147. Pallet type shall be type I (4-way entry), type IV, or type V in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L or film bonding means O or P. Pallet patterns shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size that does not conform to any of the pallet patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall first be approved by the contracting officer.

* 5.4 Marking. In addition to special markings required by the contract or purchase order, unit packs, shipping containers, and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 and ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The bags are intended for use in dry cleaning establishments as protective covers for dry cleaned garments.

* 6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.

b. Type and size of bag required (see 1.2).

c. Selection of the applicable level of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

d. When palletization is required (see 5.3).

e. When weather-resistant boxes are to be used for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).

f. When packaged rolls will be packed in boxes conforming to PPP-B-601 for level A packing (see 5.2.1).

6.3 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this document are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-B-43716B	Bags, Plastic, Protective (Garment)

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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